

COMPLIANCE COMPONENT

DEFINITION	
Name	Separation of Duties
Description	Separation of Duties refers to dividing roles and responsibilities to minimize the possibility that a single individual can cause a security breach.
Rationale	Establishes division of responsibilities and separates duties of individuals as necessary to minimize security-related risk. Malicious collusion between two or more authorized individuals is much less likely than one person engaging alone in inappropriate behavior.
Benefits	• Having different staff engaged within an end-to-end process is a common, sensible business practice that ensures consistent and successful execution of the process. • Separation of duties helps to reduce fraud and malicious damage, because any user attempting to engage in such activities would be forced to collude with at least one other user. • Separation of duties also reduces errors, because a second operator will often catch mistakes made or missed by the first.

ASSOCIATED ARCHITECTURE LEVELS	
Specify the Domain Name	Security
Specify the Discipline Name	Management Controls
Specify the Technology Area Name	Personnel Security
Specify the Product Component Name	

COMPLIANCE COMPONENT TYPE	
Document the Compliance Component Type	Guideline
Component Sub-type	

COMPLIANCE DETAIL	
State the Guideline, Standard or Legislation	Separation of duties minimizes the ability of individuals from having the information system access necessary to perform malicious activity without collusion. Examples of separation of duties include: • Agency critical functions are divided among different individuals or roles. • Distinct information system support functions and mission critical functions are divided among different individuals or roles. • Different individuals perform information system functions, examples: ○ Development ○ Testing ○ Administration (e.g. database, systems, network, etc.) ○ Physical security

	○ IT Security ○ Provisioning ○ System Log Management • In situations where the agency cannot support the differentiation of roles or a single individual performs all roles within the agency, the agency shall employ appropriate compensating controls (e.g., providing increased personnel security and auditing measures).
Document Source Reference #	NIST Special Publications: 800-53 Rev. 5 and 800-12 Rev. 1

Compliance Sources			
Name	NIST SP800-53 Rev. 5 - Recommended Security Controls for Federal Information Systems and Organizations	*Website*	nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/SpecialPublications/NIST.SP.800-53r5.pdf
Contact Information			
Name	NIST SP800-12 Rev. 1 An Introduction to Computer Security: The NIST Handbook.	*Website*	*An Introduction to Information Security (nist.gov)*
Contact Information			

KEYWORDS	
List Keywords	Management, administration, policy, procedures, planning, staffing, critical tasks, sensitive, data, collusion, responsibility, duties, fraud, data breach

COMPONENT CLASSIFICATION				
Provide the Classification	☐ *Emerging*	☒ *Current*	☐ *Twilight*	☐ *Sunset*
Sunset Date				

CURRENT STATUS				
Provide the Current Status	☐ *In Development*	☒ *Under Review*	☐ *Approved*	☐ *Rejected*

AUDIT TRAIL			
Creation Date	05/25/06	*Date Approved / Rejected*	12/18/2025
Reason for Rejection			
Last Date Reviewed	12/17/2025	*Last Date Updated*	12/18/2025
Reason for Update	Vitality		